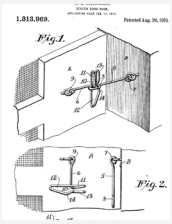
MOUNTAIN REVIEW

OFFICIAL NEWSLETTER OF THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION

Volume XV Issue 11 Summer 2025



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Disasters in Mountain View
Earthquakes, Fires, & Plane Crashes

Mountain View and its residents have lived through two major earthquakes, too many fires to recount and tragic airplane crashes. Join us as we uncover memories and forgotten stories of destruction, recovery and rebuilding.

FIRES

EARTHQUAKES

PLANE CRASHES

Sunday, August 3, 2025 ▪ 2 to 3:30 p.m. ▪ The Historic Adobe Building, 157 Moffett Boulevard ▪ Mountain View, CA

REGISTER ONLINE: http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com



News & Notes

This newsletter is published four times a year by the
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042
www.mountainviewhistorical.org

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Financial Report

As of June 30, 2025:
$15,686.82 Checking Account Balance
Certificates of Deposit: $64,224.77

Membership News

The MVHA welcomes three new members
Anthea Chung, Kathleen Jordan
and Michael Klein.

You can renew or become a member by returning the form (see page 9) with a check or using the website: https://www.mountainviewhistorical.org/memberships/. Your dues help support our organization to pay for the ongoing expenses of the newsletter production, mailing costs, insurance and meeting costs.



Pamela Baird

President's Message

By Pamela Baird *MVHA President*

The Responsibility of History

In May, my husband, his adult children and I traveled to the northern German town of Barth to attend a special commemoration.

It was the 80th anniversary of the liberation of two camps run by the Nazi government—one for Prisoners of War and the other a concentration work camp. My father-in-law was a POW in Stalag Luft 1 for about eighteen months before the regime fell and the camp was abandoned by German soldiers fleeing the advancing Russian army.

Over 150 descendants of the people held in the camps participated in the informative and sometimes emotional two-day event. The first afternoon the participants visited the memorial for the concentration work camp, where a wreath was laid beneath a panel depicting prisoners.

Then the group visited the memorial at the location of the POW camp. A wreath was also laid. The mayor of the town of about 9,000 inhabitants, Friedrich-Carl Hellwig, spoke at each location. Both speeches carried powerful messages. At the work camp he stated

"*What happened here was no secret. The camp was not hidden. It stood in plain sight...There is guilt here too. In this place... We inherit this legacy. It is heavy—and it remains. But we do not bear it because we are guilty of the past. We bear it because we are responsible for the present—and for the future. Responsible for remembrance. For truth. And for vigilance.*"



The town of Barth, Germany, where a wreath was placed below a plaque to commorate a WWII POW camp.

He continued

"*Humanity begins in the smallest of acts: in the choice to speak out, to stand firm, to care. Together with you, I wish to honor the memory, to carry its weight, and to draw from it the strength to protect what is humane, now and in the time to come. Let us remain vigilant. Let us remain humane.*"

I returned with a renewed appreciation of the German people for their commitment to remembering the past and the responsibility of history.

The Telephone Comes to Mountain View

by Pamela Baird

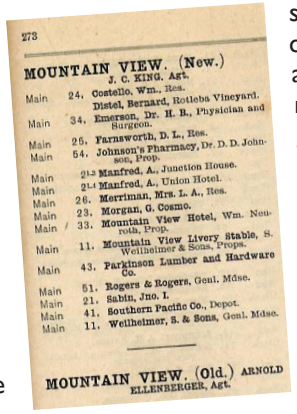
Mountain View's first telephone office was in the local drug store



Ring! Ring!
What's that sound?
It's the new telephone!

In keeping with our theme of technology introductions in Mountain View in this issue we cover the introduction of the telephone. Previously we highlighted electricity and the bicycle.

The telegraph was an integral part of commerce and communications for the United States and the world. The new technology was quickly embraced after its widespread adoption in the 1850s. In 1867 Western Union, the largest company providing services, had 2,600 offices connected by 85,000 miles of wire. By 1890, the company had 19,400 offices linked by 679,000 miles of wire. It handled 56 million messages that year. Judging from early photographs of downtown Mountain View, the city had erected telegraph poles by 1890.



273

MOUNTAIN VIEW. (New.)
J. C. KING, Agt.

Main 24. Costello, Wm., Res.
Distel, Bernard, Rotlebs Vineyard.
Main 34. Emerson, Dr. H. B., Physician and Surgeon.
Main 25. Farnsworth, D. L., Res.
Main 54. Johnson's Pharmacy, Dr. D. D. Johnson, Prop.
Main 21-3 Manfred, A., Junction House.
Main 21-4 Manfred, A., Union Hotel.
Main 26. Merriman, Mrs. L. A., Res.
Main 23. Morgan, G. Cosmo.
Main 33. Mountain View Hotel, Wm. Neuroth, Prop.
Main 11. Mountain View Livery Stable, S. Wellheimer & Sons, Props.
Main 43. Parkinson Lumber and Hardware Co.
Main 51. Rogers & Rogers, Genl. Mdse.
Main 21. Sabin, Jno. I.
Main 41. Southern Pacific Co., Depot.
Main 11. Wellheimer, S. & Sons, Genl. Mdse.

MOUNTAIN VIEW. (Old.) ARNOLD ELLENBERGER, Agt.

However, the acceptance of the telephone happened more slowly, even though most providers also handled telegram services. Many people didn't trust the new technology or thought it was a plaything of the wealthy.

Alexander Graham Bell is credited as the inventor. He received the first patent for a telephone on March 7, 1876, although other inventors were active in developing this technology. Bell advocated for answering the phone with "ahoy", a maritime greeting. Thomas Edison suggested "hello" instead.

The first telephone exchange in California was established in San Francisco in 1878. It took 16 years before an exchange was established in Mountain View. The Sunset Telephone & Telegraph Company solicited subscribers that paid a monthly fee and a per minute charge to place a phone call. In 1894 there were four subscribers in Mountain View.

The first telephone exchange was located in Johnson's Drug Store on Castro Street. The equipment needed to operate the phone system was a switchboard with manual connections performed by an operator. By 1906 the number of subscribers had grown to only 85, most of which were businesses.

The 1905 Mountain View High School yearbook displays 49 advertisers, but only ten of them had a telephone listing—about 20%.

Because there were so few subscribers, the early telephone directory books included entries from a huge area-most included the counties surrounding the San Francisco Bay. It's interesting to note that some communities like Napa, Redwood City and Ukiah had many more subscribers than Mountain View. Phone service to Sunnyvale was established in 1906 and to Los Altos in 1912.

The early directories instructed new subscribers about how to use the telephone. To reach an operator to place a phone call, a person would tap the earpiece arm three times and then stay on the line for the operator. When placing a call—"state your number carefully (example – three- eight- four). Do the same when a phone call is received so the party placing the call knows that the correct connection has been made".

By 1915 multi-arm telephone poles had been erected on Castro Street— according to photographs from that year. But in the 1915 Mountain View High School yearbook the number of advertisements displaying phone numbers is still only 20%.

But as we know, eventually the telephone was widely accepted and became an essential part of modern life. By the 1950s, roughly two-thirds of American households had at least one telephone. According to US census figures, the percentage of homes without a telephone dropped to only 2.4 percent in 2000.

And now we all use cell phones. We wonder- what would the early adopters of telephone technology think of having a phone in one's pocket?

Research assistance from Elena Lopez

Spring Event Recap Palmita Park and The Minton Legacy



On Sunday, May 4, MVHA members Melanie Kaye and Kyle Hartzell presented the story behind their book Palmita Park, The First 100 Years, about one of Mountain View's first housing subdivisions—Loreto, Anza, and Velarde streets, celebrating its centennial this year.

Conceived by lumberman Earl Minton and banker B. W. Holeman during the post-World War I housing boom, Palmita Park required every home be built with materials from the Minton Company. Buyers selected plans from Minton's California Bungalow Catalog, offering popular architectural styles of the time.

A 1924 contest awarded Mrs. C. E. Kunze $25 for the name "Palmita Park," chosen for the dwarf palms selected by Minton that lined the parkways. In 2023 neighbors replaced their signature little palms that had been lost in the winter storms and began writing a centennial history for a 20's themed celebration. Despite many remodels and modernizations, Palmita Park's bungalows still display the craftsmanship and charm that attracted middle-class families a century ago.

Ms Kaye and Ms Hartzell presented a slide show that also showcased the Minton family legacy. Their contributions to our city through community service and owning and operating one of Mountain View's longest running businesses. As Palmita Park residents, the two shared how much fun they had conducting their research at the History Center, gathering stories from neighbors, and even visiting the County Surveyor's office in San Jose. Their book is now available at the Mountain View Public Library in The History Center.

The Kindness of the Minton Family *by Margaret Nakamura Cooper*

Margaret Nakamura Cooper was born and raised in Mountain View. During World War II her family was held in an internment camp. They returned to MV after the war ended. She graduated from MVHS in 1948 and from San Jose State in 1952. Three sons were born to the couple. The family settled in Santa Maria, where she still lives in the house they purchased in 1970. She was widowed five years ago.

The Minton family was known for owning a successful lumberyard. But what may be unknown is how kind and helpful they were to the Japanese community.

This is a personal story about how Mr. Earl Minton helped my family and the community. Uncle Harry was my mother's older brother. He was very smart and wanted to become a lawyer. This was in the 1920s and his family was poor. Harry's father Yonejiro Tsuruda needed his son to go to work to help put food on the table. Upon high school graduation, his father told Harry that he had to work to help support the family. After fifteen years of servitude, he would be allowed to go to college and pursue his dream.

Earl Minton heard about this and gave Harry a job at the lumber company. A Caucasian lawyer tutored Harry during free time and Harry became familiar with basic law. When the fifteen years were over the Mintons enrolled Harry at COP (now University of the Pacific). Harry studied hard.

Unfortunately, he became ill with tuberculosis and had to drop out. The Mintons drove Harry to a sanitarium in Arizona where many sufferers of tuberculosis went to recover. While there he learned to play bridge and played with members of the staff. Unfortunately, Harry never got well and passed away. I was just a toddler when he died. My mother said she got letters from her brother asking about me.

Mrs. Margerie Minton also had a good heart. She gave me free piano lessons. Once a week I would walk from grammar school to her house, and she would teach me to play the piano. Afterwards she invited me into the breakfast nook off the kitchen and served me tea and cookies. There was always a tablecloth on the table and beautiful China dishes. I shall never forget the feeling I had at these tea parties with just the two of us. So, this is how the other half lives! I was flattered that she wanted me to experience the finer things in life.

When the Japanese Christian community needed a church Earl Minton came to the rescue. My mother's stepfather, Mr. Tsuruda owned a walnut ranch with a few raspberry bushes located on Whisman Road not far from Moffett Field. He converted to Christianity after coming from Japan in the early 1900s. Mr. Tsuruda donated a corner of his land on which to build a church. Earl Minton donated lumber and know-how. With help from the young men in the Japanese community a neat little church was built for the young Japanese American Christian children and their parents. I was one of those sansei (third generation) children who went to Sunday school every week.



Mrs. Minton (front, 4th from left) 1930s 'Girls Day' at the Minton House

At the end of her life Mrs. Minton lived in a care facility in Mountain View. I visited her once with a piece of music that she had taught me to play. She remembered the tune and we hummed it together. That was the last time I saw her. I am now 94 but the memories of the kindness of the Minton family still linger.

Editor's note *We received an email from Margaret after the Spring issue of our newsletter was released. In the issue was an article about Palmita Park, which included information about the Minton family. She included this personal story, which we are pleased to include in this issue.*

VOLUNTEER OPPORTUNITY

The MVHA is looking for a **Treasurer**— a position on the board. The ideal candidate knows accounting, bookkeeping procedures and Quickbooks. About 1-2 hours per week is the usual time commitment needed. Please contact Pamela Baird (650-740-4847) or email info@mountainviewhistorical.org.

Finding Your Family History

Adding Living Relatives to Your Family Tree

by Robert Cox, MVHA Vice President

Connecting with living relatives, particularly distant ones you have never met before, can add a new dimension to your family history research. While the facts gleaned from databases on *Family Search* or *Ancestry* are the bones of genealogical research, your living distant relatives can often share family stories and old photographs that are the flesh on those bones. Occasionally, they will provide the info to extend the part of the family tree you shared with them. And then there is the joy of sharing what you have found with them.

Public records are the best way to get started locating your distant living relatives. Here, the federal and state governments who create those records attempt to balance the public's desire to know with individual privacy. For this reason, each federal census is released only after 72 years. Birth, marriage, and death records are created by the states, and each state has its own rules on what is released and when. Most states do not release any information on minors. Texas, California, and Ohio make the most information available. Ancestry also includes information extracted from local public records, generally voter lists and property records, which can reveal a person's birth year, and sometimes month and day, if you know where the person was living at the time the record was created. Some states, like Florida, provide the date a living person was married, but do not provide the name of the spouse.

One of the best ways to link living people into your family tree is through obituaries. Starting in 2000, many people started posting obituaries online. After 2010, this practice became quite common. One web site, **legacy.com**, collects online obituaries which can be viewed by the public for free. Many obituaries contain a list of relatives of the deceased and whether the relative survives the deceased or proceeded him or her in death. Often the spouses and the locations where the surviving relatives live is given. Full names of children are usually included, sometimes the names of grandchildren. One sticking point is that a divorced spouse is rarely mentioned, so finding that spouse's name can be a challenge.

Beyond these standard records, there are search programs on the internet that can help. One of the easiest to use is White Pages, which, if you know a person's name and location, provides an estimate of the person's age and a few possible relatives. Sometimes it easy to guess whether the possible relative is a spouse, child, or parent by comparing the age of the possible relative with that of the person being searched. Beyond this, many people have Facebook, Instagram, and LinkedIn pages to which you can connect.

Mountain View Family History Spotlight

By Robert Cox

The central theme of former Mayor Laura Macias's family history is family and close friends who become like family, community, and service to others.

Laura's paternal grandfather, Adalberto Anselmo Macias, was born in Zacatecas, Mexico. He immigrated to the USA in 1901. After spending some time in San Diego, he moved to Phoenix, Arizona. Adalberto's brother became a Franciscan priest. Because Adalberto was already 36 years old, his brother suggested that it was high time Adalberto get married and start a family. So, Adalberto was introduced to Catalina Gonzales, a 38-year-old lady who worked at the parish residence. They married in 1919 and had two sons: Joe, Laura's father, and Tony Macias.



Joe Macias as a medic in World War II

During World War II, Joe served overseas as an army medic and earned a Bronze Star. Laura's mother Lydia was the last of seventeen children born to Ignacio and Angelita Flores. Lydia was born two days before the 1929 stock market crash. She grew up in the Phoenix area living on the farms where her father was employed. But as the Great Depression wore on, their family relocated to southern California, in search of work.

After World War II, Lydia's family was able to return to Arizona. As the youngest daughter, Lydia took on the responsibility of caring for her aging parents. In 1951, she met Joe Macias at a dance at Immaculate Heart Church in downtown Phoenix. They married a few months later, and were blessed with five children: Laura, the only girl, and her four brothers: Albert, Steve, Tom, and Greg. Laura began her education in a Catholic school in Phoenix. Her family was active in the Society of Saint Vincent de Paul, and instilled in her the value of helping those less fortunate.

— continued on page 6



Laura with her parents and brother Albert at the Seattle World's Fair in 1962

Pioneer of Aviation

by Carol Donahue

After the Wright Brothers and others gave exhibition flights in Europe and the USA in 1908, aviation became the next big thing. Ambitious young men and women tested their courage in aeroplanes built by a growing industry. Victor Morris Smith was one of them. Sadly, his promising career was cut short in one of the many fatal crashes of the era.

Victor was a graduate of Mountain View High School's class of 1910, where the senior directory lists his nickname as Vic and his favorite expression as "That's the candy!" Vic could usually be found "under the auto." His greatest charm was his gentle laugh; his greatest fault was stubbornness.

Later that year, Victor Smith began civil engineering studies at Stanford University. Building on his high school track training, he was one of two freshmen to win a place on the varsity track team. As a sophomore, Smith took a leave of absence to become one of the first students at the Curtiss Flying School in San Diego.

The school was started by Glenn Curtiss, who later became known as the Father of Naval Aviation. Victor completed two months of flight training and qualified for his pilot's license. He demonstrated his skills by flying a Curtiss biplane with a 50-horsepower motor over San Diego for 10 minutes and 45 seconds, completing five figure eight formations, and landing within a 50-foot radius. Then, he flew to an altitude of 165 feet and repeated the exercises, breaking world records for time in the test.

Upon his return to Mountain View, Victor Smith planned a series of exhibition and cross country flights to satisfy a curious public willing to pay for entertaining thrills. He advertised a flight from Mountain View to Ravenswood near Palo Alto. The Mountain View Register-Leader reported on July 12, 1912, that "Tickets may be bought at any store in town."



Onlookers at Smith's wreckage in a local orchard

At the eleventh hour, a Curtiss biplane model that he used at aviation school became unavailable. To avoid disappointing the hometown crowd, he obtained a flimsy biplane made by an Oakland amateur aviator. His alarmed parents and friends could not convince Victor to abandon the project. Setting aside his own doubts, Victor put a letter from his fiancée in his pocket for good luck and took off.



SAN FRANCISCO, SUNDAY, JULY 14, 1912.—PAGES 17 TO 26

Young Aviator Dashed to Death Mother Sees Stanford Boy Fall

DOG DRIVES OFF WOMAN'S RESCUER

Holder of World's Amateur Record for Speed Dies Near Palo Alto

Just before his scheduled landing, the engine died and a crowd of 400 watched Victor Morris Smith fall to his death.

On July 13, 1912, the New York Times reported "The aeroplane was caught by a gust of wind as Smith was circling to the ground, and fell fifty feet….The machine turned turtle, and Smith was hurled earthward with great force and pinioned beneath the wreckage."

Funeral services were held at the family home the day after the tragic accident. His grief-stricken parents then accompanied his remains to Evansville, Indiana, where he was born and then laid to rest among his forebears.

Thanks to Pamela Baird and James Thajudeen for research contributions.

Spotlight

— continued from page 5



Laura and her mother Lydia in 2018.

Laura had a passion for travel. She was thrilled when she received a scholarship to study at Regis University, a private Jesuit School in Denver, Colorado. Her first foray into politics was in the school's student government.

After college, Laura worked at Rolm Corporation, spending long hours in field tech support. She saved her earnings and bought a condo at the Old Mill complex on Showers Drive. She also started volunteering at the Support Network for Battered Women and then the Community Services Agency. She served on Mountain View's Parks and Recreation Commission, as the city was acquiring land for miniparks and defining its long-term parks plan.

When Sally Lieber was elected to the California Assembly, Laura served on Sally's staff. In 2004, Laura was elected to the city council, serving as mayor in 2007. Laura led the fight against Home Depot locating at the San Antonio Shopping Center. The story gained national attention, and Laura was even insulted by Rush Limbaugh. Laura notes that had Home Depot located at San Antonio, Mountain View would never have been able to build the area into the diverse, regional shopping and residential area it is today.

Laura's advice to young people seeking a political career is, "Get involved early and learn as much as you can." She adds, "Those who represent us are here to serve us."

The Crash that Changed History by David Salinero

The histories of Mountain View and Moffett Field have been intertwined for almost 100 years. Local residents organized a campaign to lure the military base close to its borders. Moffett Field has brought new residents, commerce, and educational opportunities to the city. In return, the city has provided services to military personnel and their children. Moffett Field was conceived as a lighter-than-air base, but its mission has changed several times over its history.

In the 1950s, after the Korean War, Moffett Field housed squadrons of planes assigned to aircraft carriers of the Pacific Fleet. This was the "jet age" when many flights took off and landed at Moffett Field daily. By the end of the decade, sonic booms would be a regular occurrence in the Santa Clara Valley. The planes at this time were unreliable and many of these single-engine (single-pilot) flights would end with a crash.

Most of these crashes were in the SF Bay or unpopulated areas. This was a very tense time for the leaders of the military and of the local government officials. Inevitably, disaster would strike downtown Mountain View. The crashes in the 1950s would quickly change the course of Moffett Field's mission. These crashes were debated in the local newspapers.

At the next MVHA event, we will focus on the crash of February 1, 1957, and its effects on Mountain View history. This crash took the life of a pilot, damaged many downtown homes, and made a permanent impact on the quality of life in Mountain View for decades.



The family of Capt. Robert Mulvehill Jr., who lost his life when his plane exploded over downtown Mountain View.
— Mountain View Register Leader

Fire—An Ever Present Danger

—Pamela Baird

Ever since man began living in dwellings constructed from flammable materials, fires have been a concern of both inhabitants and people living nearby. Since the rise of large cities around the world, many have been partially destroyed by fires that burned for days before they could be extinguished.

Even though Mountain View has been a relatively small community, it has had its share of fires, some very large in size but each one had an impact on the participants. Fires have been started by children playing with matches, overheated wood stove pipes, incorrect electrical wiring or unknown causes.

Arson has played a part in numerous fires. In 1928 St. Joseph's Church was burned to the ground by a fire that was intentionally set. Oil soaked rags and cans of gasoline were found under a side stairwell. In 1947 four large barn fires around Mountain View caused significant damage, evidently due to incendiary devices. A firebomb was thrown through the window of the U.S. Army recruiting office in 1972. The bomb set fire to the interior of the office.

Severe fires have challenged the livelihood of businesses. A fire caused extensive damage to the box factory owned by the Minton family in 1928. It's not known if the business was restarted. In 1906 a fire that may have started in the engraving department destroyed the Pacific Press facility on Villa Street. The facility was rebuilt, and the company remained in Mountain View until 1983 when it moved to Idaho.



1928 St. Joseph's Church burned to the ground.

Local people have acted heroically in saving people from burning buildings. In 1971 three separate incidents occurred. In January a neighbor saved a two year old girl from a flaming apartment. Gene Nicolas twice charged into the apartment looking for the child. Despite the heavy smoke, he was able to locate the child and take her to safety.

Two months later a women rescued her family members from their burning house on Villa Street. Dana Price led her three daughters, and one grandchild outside and then went back in to rouse her sleeping husband. In December Ronald Parker pulled a neighbor, 11 year old Mathew Null, to safety through a window. Mr. Parker later received a commendation from the Fire Department for his heroic effort.

Learn more about these and other fires at the August 3 History Event. It will be held at the Adobe Building. Register online: **http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com**

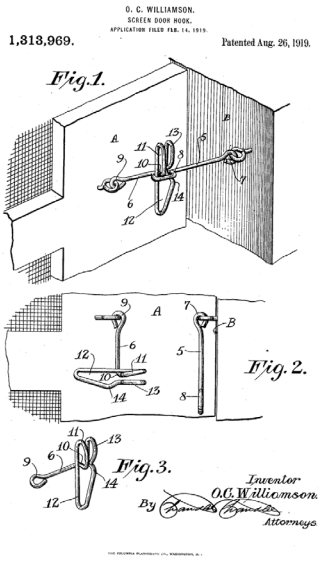
Research assistance from Yufei Song

Andrew Williamson — Tweaking a Common Device

The device that Andrew Williamson patented appears to be a tweaking of a common device—the screen door latch. The patent description states "*the primary object of the invention is, the provision of a fastener of this character wherein a closure can be readily and easily locked*".

Williamson was born in Sweden and immigrated to this country in 1868 at the age of 15. He settled in Des Moines, Iowa and later married Viola Fleming in 1895 at the age of 42. He was 15 years older than her. Based on the locations of the birth of their numerous children, they lived in Iowa, Missouri and South Dakota. The family settled in Mountain View about 1907. The 1910 and 1920 census showed the family living at 1267 Washington Street.

Williamson worked as a contractor and painter. His patent was granted in 1919 when he was 66 years old. He evidently saw the need for a latch that provided more security. We don't know if the device was manufactured.



The couple had eight children-five sons and three daughters. Perhaps that is why he wanted to have a screen door latch that easily locked!

Tragically Williamson died in September 1920 at the age of 68 after a long illness of heart disease. His youngest child was only ten years old. The Register-Leader newspaper wrote a respectful account "Mr. Williamson was a good man. He was industrious and gave an honest day's work for an honest day's pay."

Later Mrs. Williamson moved to San Francisco with some of her children. She passed away there in 1950.

The house that they owned on Washington Street was later destroyed in the construction of the Shoreline overpass above the train tracks and the Bailey/Shoreline widening project.

Jean F. Deray — Planning for a Deep Dive

TECHNOLOGY


SUNDAY MORNING, JANUARY 19, 1919.

TREASURE GIVEN UP FOR LOST MAY BE RECOVERED WITH NEW DIVING APPARATUS

Jean F. Deray of Mt. View Invents Diving Suit Capable of Great Strain.

Famous Treasure Ships, Long Lost on Ocean Floor, May Be Reached, Belief.

MOUNTAIN VIEW, Jan. 18.—Jean F. Deray of Mountain View, who has hitherto obtained some local distinction as an inventor, has on exhibition here two of his inventions, one a deep sea diving suit and the other an air pump for furnishing air to the diver.

The suit, which is of metallic composition, will stand from three to four tons pressure crushing strain. No other suit has been made capable of withstanding the strain for descending much beyond 100 feet. The suit has a telephone arrangement located in the helmet by which the diver can be in constant communication with the men at the surface. There is also a very powerful search light attached to the helmet that enables him to see for a distance of from 12 to 15 feet at any depth below the surface. He will have equally as free use of his arms and legs in the suit as in the ordinary rubber suit in common use. This feature has been one of Mr. Deray's most difficult problems to solve. The suit will effectively protect the diver against both the sharks and devil fish, which

(Concluded on Page Fifteen.)

JEAN F. DERAY AND HIS DIVING SUIT

The crazy looking diving device that Mountain View resident Jean F. Deray patented was inspired by the early 1900s worldwide fascination and demand for deep diving capability technologies. Inventors in Europe and the US were working feverishly to perfect diving suits.

Numerous shipwrecks, everything from 16th century Spanish galleons to large shipwrecks of the 1800s enticed people with dreams of finding treasure and wealth beneath the waves. Mr. Deray, a machinist and engineer, received a patent for the diving suit in May of 1914. He also patented an air pump for furnishing air to the diver. He was 38 years old.

The patent description states, "The object of the present invention is to provide a diver's suit which will withstand very great external pressure, and therefore be capable of being lowered to very great depth".

A year and a half later a company was established- the Standard Diving Company. Three men (including Deray) financed the invention. Deray and the two other owners of the invention created a corporation. In 1919 the inventions were displayed at the Neuroth Building (now the site of the Olympus Café). It is not known what success, if any, the company had in producing and selling the suits.

Deray initially worked in San Jose in a foundry. In 1904 he is mentioned in the San Jose Mercury News when he is hired by the San Jose fire department as an engineer. Deray worked there for over four years.

About 1908 he moved to Mountain View, where he lived for the rest of his life. He worked as a machinist at the Hendy Ironworks in Sunnyvale, a large manufacturer of mining equipment. He also worked as a mechanic in the Santa Clara County corporate yard in Mountain View.

It appears that 1914 was a good year for him. Not only was he granted a patent, but he also married Bertha Heidt. A year later the couple built a house at 1349 Latham. The house is still at this location. Deray died in 1955 at the age of 79 years. His widow survived him.

Early MVHS yearbooks are now online



MVHA is excited to announce that the MV Library is now hosting online a collection of Mountain View High School yearbooks. This is a unique and valuable digital resource that includes the 1904–1929 yearbooks. These books are part of the MVHA collection of artifacts and memorabilia.

The MV Library worked with a program available through California Revealed, https://californiarevealed.org, a statewide initiative that helps public libraries, archives, museums, and historical societies, to digitize, preserve, and provide online access to archival materials.

A press release from the Library states "*The yearbooks contain the names and photographs of faculty and students, as well as information about student activities, advertisements from local businesses, written reflections, short fiction, and inside jokes.*

Most of these early yearbooks also contain details about MVHS alumni and their lives post-graduation. Inside you will find details about the experience of World War I, the influenza epidemic of 1918-1919, and the Prune & Apricot Exposition. As you move through the collection from the oldest to the most recent issue you can perceive the growing importance of secondary education and the emergence of youth culture facilitated by the automobile."

The yearbook collection can be explored through the Mountain View Public Library's pages at **California Revealed**: https://californiarevealed.org/partner/mountain-view-public-library?f%5B0%5D=search_block_media_type%3AText

Internet Archive: https://archive.org/details/mountainviewlibrary?and%5B%5D=subject%3A%22High+school+students%22

Looking at the yearbooks offers a great perspective on life in a small prosperous farming community. Even if you didn't grow up here and are not familiar with the family names of early residents, looking through the books is a fun way to see how people lived over a century ago.

MEMBERSHIP FORM

The MVHA welcomes new members! You can also join/renew online at **www.mountainviewhistorical.org**. Membership is tax deductible to the extent permitted by law. The MVHA is a tax-exempt organization under Internal Revenue Code Section 501(c)(3), Tax ID 94-6115407.

☐ New Membership

☐ Membership Renewal

☐ Household Annual Membership *$30/year*

☐ Individual Lifetime Membership *$300*

☐ *I'm interested in volunteer opportunities*

Name(s) _____

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☐ *I'd like a print-edition subscription of the newsletter.(To save paper and costs, the default subscription is a digital emailed newsletter.)*

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Thank you!

SUMMER

Calendar

July 23
Genealogy talk at the Library 6:30 p.m.
https://mountainview.libcal.com/event/14444827
July 27
Downtown Walking tour 2:00 p.m.
Register on EventBrite
http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com/
August 3
History Event- Adobe Building 2:00 p.m.
Disasters in Mountain View
Earthquakes, Fires and Airplane Crashes
Register on EventBrite
http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com/
August 4
Board meeting 6:00 p.m. on Zoom
August 24
Downtown Walking tour 2:00 p.m.
Register on EventBrite
http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com/
August 27
Genealogy talk at the Library 6:30 p.m.
https://mountainview.libcal.com/event/14444858
November 2 History Event
topic and location TBD

Looking Back: Images from the Archives

Earthquakes in MV

In the space of less than 90 years two events occurred in northern California that changed people's lives, the cities in which we live and the way that we live.

The events? The earthquakes of 1906 and 1989. Each was devastating, but in different ways. Each was similar in the destruction caused.

Learn more about these earthquakes and other disasters in Mountain View at the next History Event, Sunday, August 3, at 2 p.m. at the Adobe Building. Register at http://mvhistory.eventbrite.com/.



EST. 1954
MOUNTAIN REVIEW
MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
WEB: www.mountainviewhistorical.org
EMAIL: info@mountainviewhistorical.org

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